brother, stayed with him for the night, and still "the lovely one with the glorious waist, the very mighty one, at the end of each day became a maiden again."

Vyāsa is repeatedly addressed as the son of Parasara, and Karna as the son of Surya and not of Pandu.

A legend narrated in the *Anusasana-parva* reminds us of the influence of the tradition according to which the mighty god Varuna abducts the wife of a *brāhman.* In this legend both the abductor and the abducted woman were not punished by the husband of the woman. Bhadra, Candra's daughter, was given away in marriage to Utathya, because he was very handsome and was also approved by Bhadra herself. The god Varuna wanted the girl for himself. So, once, when Utathya was out, he went to the forest regions of Yamuna and carried away Bhadra to his own underwater mansions, and enjoyed her there (I. 78).

The god Varuna is not questioned or punished for his enforced intercourse with Bhadra. Varuna, the upholder of morality, himself carries away the unprotected wife of a *brāhman* ascetic without the least compunction.

CURSING

In the epics both *brāhmans* and ascetics, are found to be the most short-tempered people. On finding the slightest breach in conduct or on the inflicting of the pettiest insult a person in cursed. As a matter of fact, the story of the *Mahābhārata* starts from a curse inflicted upon King Pariksita for disturbing a sage's penance. Similarly, Pandu is cursed because he unknowingly kills a sage who in the form of a deer was enjoying the sexual act. Cyavana, enraged at Sukanya's playful activity, curses her father with a curse which stopped the excretory function of the men in his army. Even a small impudence on the part of a king who did not give way to sage Śakti, who was a *brāhman* and had a right over the road, invited a curse. King Lomapada refused to give a *brāhman* something and because of that it did not rain in his kingdom for twelve years and all his subjects suffered along with the king who had actually committed the offense. Sage Jaratkaru abandoned his wife at a slight offense, her offense being a reminder to perform his daily duties. Uttunka cursed King Pausya for serving him food with a hair in it. The idiosyncracies of Durvasa, whose marked characteristic were a short temper and cursing, are well known.

While denouncing anger so often and so sharply, the epics declare: "The wrath of a *brāhman* is like a fire which burns not only the offender but also his family."